

Problem

An RL circuit has $R = 2\ \Omega$ and $L = 4\ \text{H}$. The time needed for the inductor current to reach 40 percent of its steady-state value is:

- (a) 0.5 s
- (b) 1 s
- (c) 2 s
- (d) 4 s
- (e) none of the above

Step-by-step solution

Step 1 of 1

We know that

$$I(t) = I_0 e^{\frac{-Rt}{L}}$$

$$\text{Or, } \frac{Rt}{L} = \ln \left[\frac{I_0}{I(t)} \right]$$

$$\text{Or, } t = \frac{L}{R} \ln \left[\frac{I_0}{I(t)} \right]$$

$$= \left(\frac{4\text{H}}{2\Omega} \right) \ln \left[\frac{1}{1-0.40} \right] \quad [40\% = 0.40]$$

$$= 1\ \text{s}$$